Sun and Moon Cookies

German · via Freeport Bakery (copycat)
~24 cookies (2-inch rounds) | Active: 45 min | Chill: 1.5 hr | Bake: 12–14 min at 350°F / 175°C

MÜRBETEIG (SHORTCRUST BASE)

Ingredients

- 250 g all-purpose flour (or 225 g AP + 25 g almond flour for extra richness)
- 150 g cold unsalted butter, cubed
- 75 g powdered sugar
- 1 large egg yolk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- Zest of ½ lemon
- Pinch of salt

Method

1. Cream butter and powdered sugar *briefly* — you want them combined, not aerated. Too much air causes the cookie to spread and lose its crisp snap.
2. Add egg yolk, vanilla, lemon zest, and salt. Mix just to combine.
3. Fold in flour until the dough just comes together. Pat into a disk, wrap, and chill at least 1 hour (overnight is fine).
4. Roll chilled dough to ~4 mm thick on a lightly floured surface. Cut 2-inch rounds. Place on parchment-lined sheets and chill the cut cookies another 20 minutes — this is what keeps them from spreading and losing their shape.

MARZIPAN BORDER

Ingredients

- 200 g almond paste (Odense, Solo, or similar — around 50% almond)
- 50 g powdered sugar
- 1 egg white, added gradually until pipeable

Method

1. Beat almond paste and powdered sugar until smooth. Add egg white a little at a time until the mixture is pipeable but still holds a stiff peak. If it slumps when piped, it's too wet — beat in more powdered sugar.
2. Load into a piping bag fitted with a small star tip (Wilton 18 or similar).
3. On each chilled cookie, pipe a ring around the edge, then a short bar across the middle to divide the center into two wells.

FILLINGS AND FINISH

Ingredients

- Good-quality apricot preserves (warmed and strained smooth)
- Good-quality raspberry or red currant preserves (same treatment)
- 1 egg yolk + 1 tsp cream, for egg wash

Method

1. Spoon apricot into one well, raspberry into the other. Don't overfill — the jam will bubble up during baking.
2. Brush the exposed marzipan gently with egg wash.

Sun and Moon Cookies — continued

3. Bake at 350°F / 175°C for 12–14 minutes, until the marzipan is golden and the base is set but not browned on top. Cool completely on the sheet — the jam will be molten when hot and sets as it cools.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Base spreads too much:** more chilling after cutting, or sub 10% of the AP flour with rice flour for extra snap.
- **Marzipan border collapses:** your paste is too wet — add more powdered sugar until it holds a stiff peak when piped.
- **Jam sinks into the cookie:** pre-bake the base with marzipan alone for 5 minutes, then add the jam and finish baking.
- **Cookies browning on the bottom:** double up your sheet pans or use an insulated sheet. These should stay pale on the bottom.

STORAGE

Store in an airtight container at room temperature for up to 4 days. The texture is best on day 1–2; after that the base softens from the jam. Dough can be made and chilled up to 3 days ahead, or frozen up to a month.